



Speedlink Virtuus Keyboard

Watch the exclusive unboxing of the Speedlink Virtuus Keyboard – a German hardware brand <http://dgit.in/slnkvr>

Snapchat: New Features

Snapchat adds new features ahead of the holiday season, adds smart filters, Replay and more. Read about it on <http://dgit.in/sciosnew>

SteamOS

A detailed look

Valve's very own linux fork for the upcoming Steam console has been released to the general public and we take a good look at the inner workings of the operating system.

Mithun Mohandas

readersletters@thinkdigit.com

Steam is pretty big in itself. It's the most popular game distribution platform and has close to 6.3 million concurrent users at peak hours but the overall accounts on steam far outnumber all other platforms combined. The client works on Windows, Mac and Linux. However, the games supported in Mac and Linux aren't that many but with the standardisation that steam brings to the picture we'll be seeing the change happening soon and hopefully AAA titles will start making Linux ports as well.

What is SteamOS?

So with all the hullabaloo around the introduction of the eighth generation consoles by Microsoft, Sony and Nintendo there was a little announcement by Valve in September this year. The first was about SteamOS then came the one about Steam Machines and finally about the Steam Controller. The three are obviously linked together and here's how.

The Steam Machine is Valve's answer to consoles except for the fact that anyone can make a Steam Machine. You don't have to go out of your way and buy a console all you need to worry is about getting the



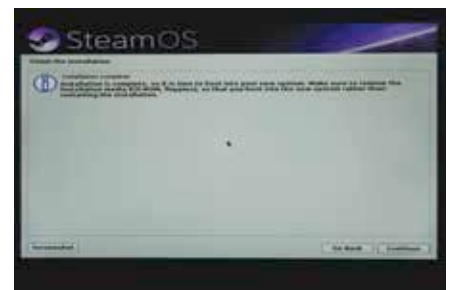
configuration high enough for playing whatever game you want to.

SteamOS is simply the operating system which is designed to run on Steam Machines. It is a Linux fork so pretty much every device under the sun will be supported without the need for fussing over driver issues. However, the only place

where there is a slight drawback is that the drivers for Graphics cards have been a persistent issue as far as Linux is concerned. But Valve has been working with NVIDIA to get that sorted at currently only NVIDIA cards are said to run the games but since it is Linux we're talking about we don't need to worry since third party drivers exist.



Choose the automated install



Once installation is complete, let it reboot